

# PRAYING AT HOME: A BEGINNER'S PRAYER RULE

## SESSION 00.11 HANDOUT

NAME \_\_\_\_\_ DATE \_\_\_\_\_

### ♦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

The Apostle Paul wrote this to the Christians in Thessalonica. It is the heart of why Orthodox Christians keep a daily prayer rule — and why we say short prayers like the Jesus Prayer over and over throughout the day. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

*Pray without ceasing. In everything give thanks; for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you. — 1 Thessalonians 5:17–18*

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### ♦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

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|---------------|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRAYER CORNER | • | • Twelve words. The shortest of the great Orthodox prayers. Said over and over, slowly, throughout the day. <i>Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, have mercy on me, a sinner.</i> |
| TRISAGION     | • | • A small place in your home, on an east-facing wall, where icons of Christ and the Theotokos hang and a candle is lit during prayer. Yours, for life.                        |
| LORD'S PRAYER | • | • <i>Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.</i> Said three times. The most ancient Orthodox prayer outside the Lord's Prayer.                                |
| JESUS PRAYER  | • | • <i>Our Father, Who art in heaven...</i> The prayer Christ Himself taught His disciples when they asked Him how to pray.                                                     |

### ♦ SEQUENCE — THE ORDER OF MORNING PRAYER

Your morning prayer rule has a specific order. Number these from **1** to **6** in the boxes below.

- ☐ Cross yourself: *In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.*
- ☐ Ask God to bless the day ahead: *Lord, bless this day. Be with me in everything I do. Help me to love. Amen.*
- ☐ Stand before your icons. Light the candle.
- ☐ Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly: *Our Father, Who art in heaven...*
- ☐ Pray *Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.* (Three times)
- ☐ Cross yourself one more time. You are ready.

### ♦ SKETCH — YOUR PRAYER CORNER

Draw your prayer corner in the box below. Show:

- The **east-facing wall** where the icons hang
- An icon of **Christ Pantocrator** (Christ as ruler of all)
- An icon of the **Theotokos** (your Mother)

- An icon of **St. Herman of Alaska** (your patron — you'll meet him next month)
- A **candle or oil lamp** below the icons
- Anything else you want to add (your Bible, a prayer book, photos of family members who have died)

[ draw your prayer corner ]

### ✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

The lesson said: *five minutes a day, every day. That is the rule.* Five minutes faithfully kept becomes a real spiritual life over decades. Write 3 to 5 sentences. What was it like to set up your prayer corner this week? What did it feel like to stand in front of your own icons in your own home? Did anything feel hard? *It's okay if your mind wandered. It's okay if it felt awkward. Most Orthodox Christians say it took weeks before standing at the corner started to feel natural. You are at the very beginning.*

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